ENGLISH I · WEEK 2

English I week 2 rules: Parts of speech and grammar

Nouns & pronouns · Verbs, tenses & modals · Adjectives & adverbs. Save this PDF for revision.

NOUNS & PRONOUNS · IN EVERY PAPER

Types of nouns

Type	What it names	Examples
Proper	A specific name (capital letter)	Shraddha, Raghav, Chennai
Common	A general kind of thing	student, city, book, walk
Collective	A group as one unit	team, jury, herd, committee, parliament
Abstract	An idea, quality or state	goodness, youth, poverty, success, happiness

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Types of nouns

Type	What it names	Examples
Material	A substance	gold, wood, water
Compound	Two or more words acting as one noun	swimming pool, toothpaste, mother-in-law
Uncountable	Can't be counted one by one	advice, information, furniture, luggage

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Pronouns

Kind	Words
Personal	I, you, he, she, it, we, they · me, him, her, us, them
Possessive (stand alone)	mine, yours, his, hers, ours, theirs: 'That is yours.'
Possessive (before a noun)	my, your, his, her, our, their: the answer keys mark these Pronoun
Reflexive	myself, yourself, themselves

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Pronouns

Kind	Words
Demonstrative	this, that, these, those
Interrogative	who (subject), whom (object), whose, which, what
Relative	who, whom, whose, which, that
Indefinite	someone, anyone, everyone, nobody, each

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Common traps

⚠ 'Swimming pool' is a compound noun, not adjective + noun.

⚠ yours, hers, theirs never take an apostrophe.

⚠ Multi-select: when a sentence has two nouns, tick both.

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Modals

Modal	Use	Example
can	ability; informal permission	Sudha can speak Telugu. (PYQ)
could	past ability; polite request	Could you help me?
may	formal permission; possibility	May I ask a question? (PYQ)
might	weak possibility	It might rain.
must	obligation; strong certainty	You must wear a helmet.

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Modals

Modal	Use	Example
should	advice, duty	You should rest.
will / shall	future; offers with I/we	Shall we go?
would	polite request; hypothetical	Would you like tea?
ought to	moral duty	We ought to help.

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Tense signals

Signal words	Tense	Example
since, for, ever, never, just, already, yet	Present perfect	She has not read anything since Monday. (PYQ)
yesterday, last year, ago, in 2010	Past simple	They bought the house last year. (PYQ)
now, at the moment	Present continuous	He is writing now.
every day, usually, always	Present simple	She usually walks to work.
by + a future time	Future perfect	By next June, she will have completed her degree.

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Agreement and form rules

A as well as / along with / with B

the verb agrees with A

'The teacher, as well as the students, is responsible.' (PYQ)

Either … or / neither … nor

the verb agrees with the nearer subject

Each, every, everyone, one of the

singular verb

The number of / a number of

singular / plural

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get / have + object + past participle

causative

'We will get it done.' (PYQ)

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Confusables

Pair	Rule
tell / say	tell + a person ('Don't tell me…', PYQ); say + the words ('say that…')
affect / effect	affect = verb, to influence ('The storm affected the coast', PYQ); effect = noun, a result
lie / lay	lie = rest (no object); lay = put something down
rise / raise	rise has no object; raise needs one

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Common traps

⚠ 'Since' needs a starting point (since Monday); 'for' needs a length of time (for two days).

⚠ Never use the past simple with since/for/ever: 'I have seen it', not 'I saw it ever'.

ADJECTIVES & ADVERBS · IN EVERY PAPER

Key points

- An adjective describes a noun: ripe tomatoes; the house was painted yellow (PYQs).
- An adverb modifies a verb, an adjective or another adverb: walk carefully, walked slowly, very happy.
- Kinds of adverb: manner (slowly), place (here), time (yesterday), frequency (usually), degree (very, quite, too).

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Key points

- 'Rinku reads quite clearly': both quite and clearly are adverbs (PYQ, multi-select).
- 'Joseph ran faster than everyone': faster is a comparative adverb, because it modifies ran (PYQ).
- 'She yelled when she hit her toe': yelled is a verb (PYQ).

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Degrees of comparison

Positive	Comparative	Superlative
good / well	better	best
bad	worse	worst
many / much	more	most
little	less	least
far	farther / further	farthest / furthest
fast	faster (PYQ)	fastest

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Making -ly adverbs

Adjective	Adverb
suitable	suitably (PYQ)
happy	happily
true	truly
gentle	gently
basic	basically

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Common traps

- ⚠ Comparative + than: 'better than', never 'more better'.
- ⚠ Superlatives take 'the': 'the best chocolate cake' (PYQ).
- ⚠ too = excessively or also ('too many people', PYQ); to = towards or infinitive; two = 2.
- ⚠ Not every -ly word is an adverb: friendly, lovely and lonely are adjectives.

Notes for every week of English I, free.

Full notes, the rule sheet and common traps, with worked PYQs.

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